

manages to beat the iQOO Neo 7 in the Single Core test, surprisingly! In PCMark-Work, the phone coughs up the highest score of the lot, which means it will be a reliable performer in daily workload tasks such as sheets, web browsing, photo and video editing, and more. All this while not throttling much! In the CPU Throttling Test, the phone throttled to only 83 per cent of its peak performance after 30 minutes, which is fantastic.

Moving on to GPU tests, the Motorola Edge 40 continues to impress. It got a score of 4,479 in 3D Mark Wild Life Extreme which is only rivalled by the iQOO Neo 7 (POCO F5 didn't support this test). The phone proved its mettle in GFXBench too with impressive scores across the board. Despite these scores, the Motorola Edge 40 is not the best option for gaming at this price. That title would have to go to the POCO F5 and the iQOO Neo 7. The phone got considerably warm after 15-30 minutes of Call of Duty: Mobile which is when we began to notice a couple of frame skips.

In general, though, the Motorola Edge 40 is a solid and reliable performer under ₹30,000. Multitasking is a smooth affair and the phone can handle most of what you throw at it, with ease. Running Android 13 out of the box, Moto's MyUX software is largely bloatware-free and very easy to navigate. There are also perks such as Ready For, Family Spaces and Moto Secure with ThinkShield. Ready For is particularly handy since it allows you to connect your phone wirelessly to a TV or display to play games, make video calls, and more, while still having a fully-functioning phone on the side. Overall, a massive thumbs up for the Motorola Edge 40's performance and UI, if you're not a hardcore gamer.

CAMERAS

In 2023, when smartphone OEMs everywhere are packing on more and more cameras in their smartphones, Motorola has actually removed a lens from the Motorola Edge 40's rear camera setup compared to its predecessor. The phone features a 50 MP primary sensor with OIS support, but the kicker here is its wide aperture of f/1.4. This allows for great low-light pictures and close-up shots with excellent natural depth

of field. You've also got a secondary 13 MP shooter which doubles as an ultrawide camera and a macro shooter. The Moto Edge 30 had a 50 MP ultrawide camera though, so this is a bit of a downgrade. Nevertheless, the added functionality of a good-quality macro camera makes the tradeoff seem manageable.

In my time with the Motorola Edge 40, the primary camera clicked detailed shots with decent dynamic range in daylight. Shadows can appear a bit crushed at times though. Also, there's an obvious amount of over-saturation that makes the shots look more social-media-ready but also a bit unrealistic. Nevertheless, if you like poppy colours, this will be right up your wheelhouse. Additionally, the primary camera also shoots impressive portrait shots with very natural skin tones, good detail, and solid edge detection. Overall, this is an impressive primary camera in daylight, if you ignore some small nitpicks.

Ultrawide photos have great dynamic range and surprisingly, the colour science between the primary and ultrawide camera is very close, which I love to see. Macro photos taken with this lens also come out looking surprisingly detailed. Low-light shots from this lens are quite grainy but the primary camera can take some amazingly detailed nighttime shots.

As for selfies, in good lighting, you will get solid results with little to complain about. However, if the lighting is even slightly unfavourable, the selfie camera can boost the highlights a bit too much. In low light, the selfie camera does have quite a bit of noise as well. So, you won't get consistently great performance with the Motorola Edge 40's selfie shooter.

BATTERY LIFE

Battery life was one area of concern on the Motorola Edge 30 since it had a tiny 4,020 mAh cell. This time around, most of those worries are dispelled since the Edge 40 now sports a 4,400 mAh battery while still housing a similarly-sized screen with the same refresh rate. So, naturally, the battery life of the Motorola Edge 40 has definitely improved. In our 4K video loop test, the Motorola Edge 40 lasted a healthy 13 hours and 24 minutes. So, it outperforms the

POCO F5 and the Samsung Galaxy A34 here. Similarly, it only lost 4 per cent battery when streaming Netflix for half an hour and dropped by 5 per cent after playing Call of Duty: Mobile for 15 minutes. This is not the best in the segment, but it is a solid improvement. Motorola has also bumped up charging speeds with this one. You get a super fast 68 W charger in the box that tops up the phone from empty to full in just 49 minutes. In fact, 0-50 per cent happens at a much faster rate. Not just that, Motorola also added wireless charging to this segment, which is a true rarity. You can wirelessly charge this phone up to 15 W on any Qi-certified wireless charger.

VERDICT

Motorola is generating some serious buzz for its smartphones, all because they're giving the users what they want. A clean software experience, stylish and lightweight design, dependable performance, and fast charging to name a few. The Motorola Edge 40 is my favourite mid-range all-rounder so far this year.

Not because of its performance chops – there are faster performers – but because it offers users a holistic experience with very few compromises. The Motorola Edge 40 also wins due to its IP68 build, wireless charging support, good primary camera, and a seriously premium design that makes it look like it is worth at least ₹45,000-₹50,000. All of this at just ₹29,999! Motorola has truly found a recipe for success with the fantastic Edge 40!

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 8020 | RAM: 8 GB LPDDR4x | Internal storage: 256 GB UFS 3.1 | OS: Android 13, MyUX | Battery capacity: 4,400 mAh | Charging: 68 W TurboPower Wired, 15 W Wireless | Display size: 6.55-inches | Display resolution: Full HD+, 402 ppi | Display technology: pOLED, HDR10+, 144 Hz refresh rate | Thickness: 7.58 mm | Weight: 171 g | IP Protection: IP68 | Cameras (rear): 50 MP OIS + 13 MP | Camera (front): 32 MP

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